MASTERFUNCTIONALSKILLS

★ OFQUAL REGULATED STANDARDS

DIGITAL FUNCTIONAL SKILLS (DFSQ) — Digital DFSQ Standard

Digital Functional Skills Revision Cards

Spreadsheet Formulas • Online Security • Devices

- ★ Essential Excel/Sheets Formulas (=SUM, =AVERAGE)
- ★ Strong Passwords & Two-Factor Authentication
- ★ File Extensions (.pdf, .docx, .xlsx, .csv)
- ★ Phishing Detection & GDPR Privacy Rules

A6 Postcard Cardstock (148 × 105 mm)

Turn over for Deck Contents & Checklist ➔

masterfunctionalskills.co.uk

1. OS Settings & Accessibility

DEVICES & HANDLING

Tailoring Your Device

Accessibility settings assist users with physical or cognitive impairments: High Contrast Mode (visual clarity), Text Scaling / Magnifier (enlarging text), Screen Reader (Narrator), Sticky Keys (motor support).

ACCESSIBILITY SETTINGS

- **High Contrast & Dark Mode (Low vision)**
- **Screen Magnifier / Zoom (Large font scaling)**
- **Screen Reader / Text-to-Speech (Dyslexia & blind)**

★ Golden Rule: Accessibility features ensure digital inclusion for all users!

⚠️ Watch Out: Don't confuse display brightness with high-contrast accessibility themes.

2. File Management & Naming

DEVICES & HANDLING

Hierarchical Folders & Version Control

Organise files into logical tree hierarchies: Root Folder → Subfolder → Specific file. Meaningful naming convention: Topic_Project_Date_Version (e.g. Budget_Q3_2024_v2.xlsx). Avoid 'Doc1.docx'.

📁 Documents (Root Folder)

└── 📁 Oxford_Health_Project (Subfolder)

├── 📄 Meeting_Notes_12Oct24.docx

└── 📊 Financial_Forecast_v3.xlsx

★ Golden Rule: Include the date (YYYY-MM-DD) and version number (v1, v2) in filename!

⚠️ Watch Out: Avoid saving everything to your Desktop — it causes system clutter and data loss risk.

3. File Extensions & Formats

DEVICES & HANDLING

Recognising Common File Types

.docx = Word processing. .pdf = Portable read-only document (universal). .xlsx / .csv = Spreadsheets / raw comma-separated data. .pptx = Slideshow. .png / .jpg = Images. .mp4 = Video. .zip = Compressed folder.

FILE FORMAT QUICK REFERENCE

- **.docx: Editable text document (Word)**
- **.pdf: Fixed layout, non-editable reader format**
- **.xlsx / .csv: Financial spreadsheets & data tables**

★ Golden Rule: Export to PDF before sharing to keep layout and formatting intact!

⚠️ Watch Out: A .csv file saves raw data only — all formulas and styling are lost.

Challenge: OS Settings & Accessibility

DEVICES & HANDLING

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 1.1

Which accessibility feature allows a user with visual impairment to hear text read aloud from the screen?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

A screen reader (or text-to-speech / Narrator).

📋 DECK CONTENTS & REVISION CHECKLIST

50 Revision Cards

Tick [✓] Read when you understand the rule, and [★] Solved when you answer the challenge! Pearson & C&G Aligned

1. OS Settings & Accessibility (DFS 1.1)
2. File Management & Naming (DFS 1.2)
3. File Extensions & Formats (DFS 1.3)
4. Cloud Storage & Syncing (DFS 1.4)
5. Search Engine Operators (DFS 1.5)
6. Evaluating Online Information (DFS 1.6)
7. Device Storage vs RAM (DFS 1.7)
8. Compressing & Extracting (.zip) (DFS 1.8)
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11. Word Processing: Headings & Styles (DFS 2.1)
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13. Images & Text Wrapping (DFS 2.3)
14. Spreadsheets: Anatomy of a Sheet (DFS 2.4)
15. Spreadsheets: Basic Arithmetic (DFS 2.5)
16. Spreadsheets: SUM & AVERAGE (DFS 2.6)
17. Spreadsheets: COUNT vs COUNTA (DFS 2.7)
18. Spreadsheets: Simple IF Statements (DFS 2.8)
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20. Spreadsheets: Creating Charts (DFS 2.10)
21. Presentations: Slide Design (DFS 2.11)
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24. Exporting & Converting to PDF (DFS 2.14)
25. Professional Email Structure (DFS 3.1)
26. Email Fields: To, Cc & Bcc (DFS 3.2)
27. Email Attachments & Cloud Links (DFS 3.3)
28. Video Calling Setup & Etiquette (DFS 3.4)
29. Workplace Messaging (Teams/Slack) (DFS 3.5)
30. Online Calendar Invites & Scheduling (DFS 3.6)
31. Digital Netiquette & Tone (DFS 3.7)
32. Document Sharing Permissions (DFS 3.8)
33. Secure Online Purchasing & HTTPS (DFS 4.1)
34. Payment Methods & Section 75 (DFS 4.2)
35. Online Banking & Statements (DFS 4.3)
36. Two-Factor Authentication (2FA) (DFS 4.4)
37. Accessing Public Services Online (DFS 4.5)
38. Online Consumer Rights & Returns (DFS 4.6)
39. Digital Receipts & Order Tracking (DFS 4.7)
40. Subscriptions & Auto-Renewals (DFS 4.8)
41. Strong Passwords & Passphrases (DFS 5.1)
42. Password Managers & Safe Storage (DFS 5.2)
43. Spotting Phishing & Smishing (DFS 5.3)
44. Malware, Viruses & Ransomware (DFS 5.4)
45. Software Updates & Security Patches (DFS 5.5)
46. Public Wi-Fi Risks & VPNs (DFS 5.6)
47. Social Media Privacy Settings (DFS 5.7)
48. Digital Footprint & Reputation (DFS 5.8)
49. Digital Wellbeing & Ergonomics (DFS 5.9)
50. Copyright & Creative Commons (DFS 5.10)

💡 **Tutor Golden Tip (Abdul):** Do not flip the card immediately! Attempt the Quick Challenge on the back using a dry-wipe pen or scratchpad first. Verify with the step-by-step model steps only after completing your working.

Challenge: File Extensions & Formats

DEVICES & HANDLING

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 1.3

Which file format should you choose to ensure a formal report cannot be accidentally altered by the recipient?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

PDF (.pdf - Portable Document Format).

Challenge: File Management & Naming

DEVICES & HANDLING

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 1.2

Suggest a professional filename for the second draft of a staff training plan written in October 2024.

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

Staff_Training_Plan_Oct2024_v2.docx.

4. Cloud Storage & Syncing

DEVICES & HANDLING

Remote Servers & Multi-Device Access

Cloud storage (OneDrive, Google Drive, iCloud) stores files on secure remote servers over the Internet. Benefits: Automatic backup, access from any device, easy real-time collaboration. Requires internet connectivity.

CLOUD STORAGE ADVANTAGES

- ✓ Access files from phone, tablet, and PC
- ✓ Automatic real-time off-site backup
- ✓ Multiple people can edit simultaneously

⋆ Golden Rule: Cloud files protect you against hardware crashes, fires, or stolen laptops!

⚠ Watch Out: If you don't enable 'Keep on this device' (offline mode), you cannot open cloud files without Wi-Fi.

5. Search Engine Operators

DEVICES & HANDLING

Boolean & Precision Search Tricks

Quotation Marks ("..."): Searches for the EXACT phrase in that precise order. Minus Sign (-word): Excludes unwanted results. site:gov.uk: Restricts search to official government websites.

ADVANCED SEARCH OPERATORS

"functional skills maths" → Exact phrase only

jaguar speed -car → Excludes automobile results

site:gov.uk apprenticeship → Official sites only

⋆ Golden Rule: Use quotation marks to search for exact multi-word terms!

⚠ Watch Out: Don't put a space after the minus sign (type '-car', NOT '- car').

6. Evaluating Online Information

DEVICES & HANDLING

Domains & Sponsored Ads

Top-level domains: .gov.uk = Official UK government. .ac.uk = Universities. .org = Non-profit organisations. .com / .co.uk = Commercial businesses. Look out for 'Sponsored / Ad' tags at top of search results.

CHECKING WEBSITE RELIABILITY

.gov.uk & .nhs.uk: Highly authoritative

.ac.uk: Academic university research

Sponsored / Ad tags: Commercial promotion

⋆ Golden Rule: Cross-check web information across at least two trusted sources!

⚠ Watch Out: Watch for lookalike URLs and typosquatting domains (e.g. paypa1.com).

7. Device Storage vs RAM

DEVICES & HANDLING

Storage (SSD/Hard Drive) vs RAM

Storage (GB/TB): Permanent memory holding files and apps when PC is turned off. RAM (Random Access Memory): Temporary working memory used while apps are open. Free up storage by deleting temp files and emptying Recycle Bin.

STORAGE (SSD/HDD)

- • Permanent file storage
- • 256 GB / 1 TB
- • Survives restarts

MEMORY (RAM)

- • Active app workspace
- • 8 GB / 16 GB
- • Clears on restart

⋆ Golden Rule: Empty your Recycle Bin / Trash to permanently reclaim disk storage!

⚠ Watch Out: Running out of RAM makes your computer freeze; running out of Storage prevents saving new files.

Challenge: Search Engine Operators

DEVICES & HANDLING

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 1.5

What search query would you type to find exact information on NHS dental fees while excluding private dentists?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

"NHS dental fees" -private (or site:nhs.uk "dental fees").

Challenge: Cloud Storage & Syncing

DEVICES & HANDLING

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 1.4

State two benefits of saving business documents to cloud storage rather than a local USB flash drive.

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

1. Files are backed up remotely if the physical device is lost/damaged. 2. Documents can be accessed from any location or device with internet.

Challenge: Device Storage vs RAM

DEVICES & HANDLING

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 1.7

State two actions you can take if your smartphone displays a 'Storage Full' warning.

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

1. Delete unused apps or clear app caches. 2. Back up photos/videos to cloud storage or delete large video files.

Challenge: Evaluating Online Information

DEVICES & HANDLING

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 1.6

Why is information found on a .gov.uk website generally more reliable than a .com website for renewing a passport?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

.gov.uk is the official UK government portal, whereas .com sites are commercial agencies that often charge extra fees.

8. Compressing & Extracting (.zip)

DEVICES & HANDLING

Reducing File Size for Email

Compress (Zip): Shrinks file size and bundles multiple documents into one single .zip folder for emailing. Extract: Unpacks the zipped files into normal editable documents.

ZIPPING & EXTRACTING FILES

Compress: Right-click → 'Send to compressed folder'

Combines 10 files into 1 small .zip attachment

Extract: Right-click .zip → 'Extract All...' to view

★ Golden Rule: You must EXTRACT files before you can properly edit and save them!

⚠️ Watch Out: If you edit files directly inside an unextracted zip, changes may be lost.

9. Basic Troubleshooting

DEVICES & HANDLING

First Steps When Tech Fails

App frozen: Open Task Manager (Ctrl + Shift + Esc) and select 'End Task'. Wi-Fi dropped: Check flight mode, restart router, toggle Wi-Fi off and on. Total system freeze: Hold power button for 10 seconds to reboot.

FIRST RESPONSE TROUBLESHOOTING

1. App Frozen? Press Ctrl+Shift+Esc → 'End Task'

2. No Internet? Check Airplane mode & restart Wi-Fi router

3. The Golden Rule: Restart the computer before calling IT!

★ Golden Rule: Restarting clears memory caches — try it first before calling support!

⚠️ Watch Out: Never unplug a PC while it is writing data or installing updates.

10. Data Protection & UK GDPR

DEVICES & HANDLING

Handling Personal Data Lawfully

Personal data relates to an identifiable living person (names, NHS numbers, addresses). Under UK GDPR: 1. Process lawfully, fairly, and transparently. 2. Keep accurate and secure. 3. Delete when no longer required.

UK GDPR KEY PRINCIPLES

- **Collect only the data that is strictly necessary**
- **Keep data secure with encryption & passwords**
- **Never share patient/client records without consent**

★ Golden Rule: Always lock your computer screen (Win + L) when leaving your desk!

⚠️ Watch Out: Leaving customer spreadsheets visible on an unattended screen is a serious GDPR data breach.

11. Word Processing: Headings & Styles

CREATING CONTENT

H1, H2 & Consistent Hierarchy

Use built-in Heading Styles (Heading 1 for main titles, Heading 2 for subheadings) instead of manually bolding and enlarging text. This creates an automatic table of contents and screen-reader structure.

BUILT-IN HEADING STYLES

Heading 1: Major Document Title

Heading 2: Section Subheading

Normal: Body text with 1.15 line spacing

★ Golden Rule: Use Heading styles to automatically create clickable Contents pages!

⚠️ Watch Out: Use Ctrl + Enter for new pages — never press Enter multiple times.

Challenge: Basic Troubleshooting

DEVICES & HANDLING

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 1.9

What keyboard shortcut opens Windows Task Manager directly to close a frozen program?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

Ctrl + Shift + Esc (or Ctrl + Alt + Delete).

Challenge: Compressing & Extracting (.zip)

DEVICES & HANDLING

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 1.8

Why is it beneficial to zip five large image files before sending them by email?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

Zipping reduces the overall file size to fit within email attachment limits and bundles all images into one file.

Challenge: Word Processing: Headings & Styles

CREATING CONTENT

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 2.1

What keyboard shortcut inserts a new page break instantly in Microsoft Word or Google Docs?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

Ctrl + Enter.

Challenge: Data Protection & UK GDPR

DEVICES & HANDLING

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 1.10

State two ways you can protect sensitive customer data on a workplace laptop.

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

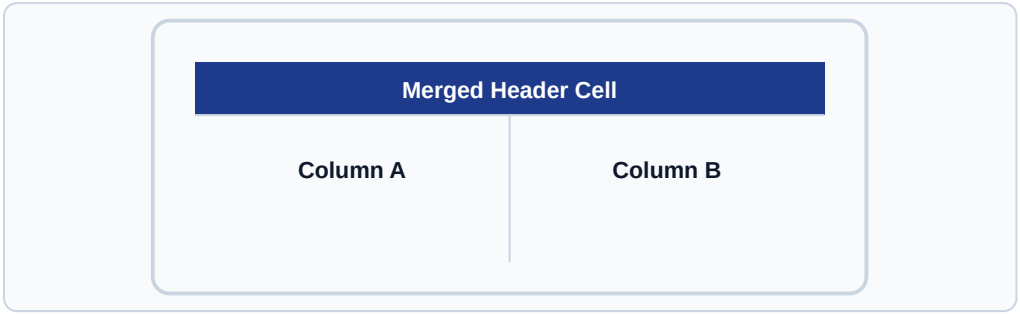
1. Use strong password protection / encryption. 2. Lock your screen whenever stepping away from the device.

12. Word Processing: Tables & Lists

CREATING CONTENT

Organising Information into Columns

Tables: Insert rows and columns to align comparative data neatly. Merge cells to create spanning banner headers. Set header rows to repeat across page breaks.



⋆ Golden Rule: Use tables to align numbers and facts rather than pressing the Spacebar or Tab key!

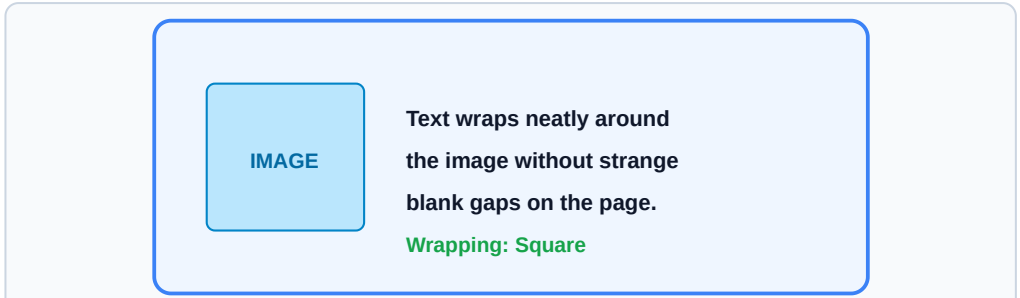
⚠️ Watch Out: Never align text by tapping the spacebar repeatedly — it falls out of alignment on other screens.

13. Images & Text Wrapping

CREATING CONTENT

Square, Tight & Aspect Ratio

Always resize images using CORNER handles to maintain original aspect ratio (prevent squishing). Text Wrapping: 'Square' or 'Tight' wraps text smoothly around the picture. Always add Alt Text for accessibility.



⋆ Golden Rule: Drag corner handles only so images keep their proper proportions!

⚠️ Watch Out: Always add Alt Text to images for accessibility and screen readers.

14. Spreadsheets: Anatomy of a Sheet

CREATING CONTENT

Columns, Rows & Cell References

Columns: Lettered vertically (A, B, C...). Rows: Numbered horizontally (1, 2, 3...). Cell Reference: The intersection letter + number (e.g. B4 = column B, row 4). Format cells as Currency (£), Percentage (%), or Date.



⋆ Golden Rule: Column Letter ALWAYS comes before the Row Number (e.g. C5, NEVER 5C)!

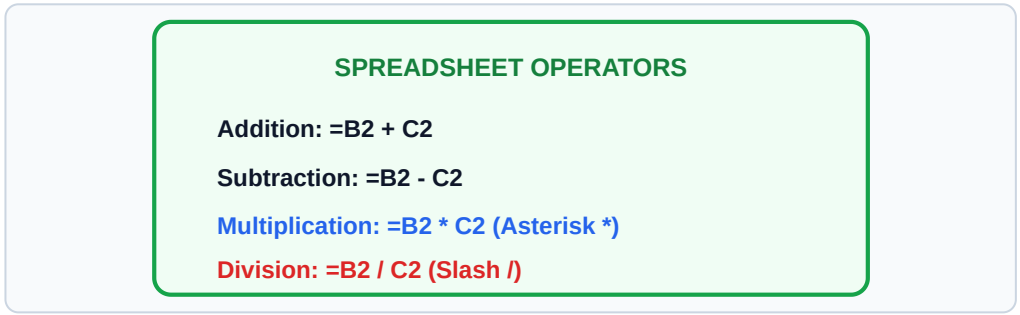
⚠️ Watch Out: Format raw numbers as Currency (£) so the pound sign appears automatically.

15. Spreadsheets: Basic Arithmetic

CREATING CONTENT

Always Start with an Equals Sign (=)

Every formula in Excel / Google Sheets MUST begin with '=': Add: =A1+B1. Subtract: =A1-B1. Multiply: =A1*B1 (asterisk). Divide: =A1/B1 (forward slash). Never type hardcoded numbers into formulas.



⋆ Golden Rule: Always begin spreadsheet formulas with '=' (e.g. =A1+B1)!

⚠️ Watch Out: Use '*' to multiply and '/' to divide — never type the letter 'x'.

Challenge: Images & Text Wrapping

CREATING CONTENT

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 2.3

Why should you provide Alt Text (alternative text) when inserting an image into a document or website?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

Alt Text allows screen readers to describe the image to visually impaired users.

Challenge: Word Processing: Tables & Lists

CREATING CONTENT

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 2.2

What table feature combines two or more adjacent cells into a single large cell?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

Merge Cells.

Challenge: Spreadsheets: Basic Arithmetic

CREATING CONTENT

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 2.5

Write the formula to multiply the quantity in cell B4 by the unit price in cell C4.

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

=B4*C4.

Challenge: Spreadsheets: Anatomy of a Sheet

CREATING CONTENT

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 2.4

What cell reference is located at the intersection of column D and row 14?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

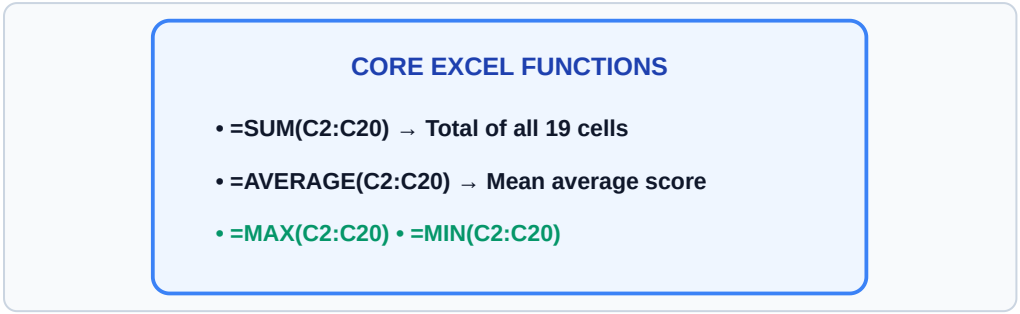
D14.

16. Spreadsheets: SUM & AVERAGE

CREATING CONTENT

Ranges with Colons (e.g. B2:B10)

=SUM(B2:B10): Adds all numbers in range. =AVERAGE(B2:B10): Calculates mean. =MAX(B2:B10): Finds highest value. =MIN(B2:B10): Finds lowest value. Colon (:) means 'through to'.



★ Golden Rule: The colon (:) indicates a contiguous cell range from start to finish!

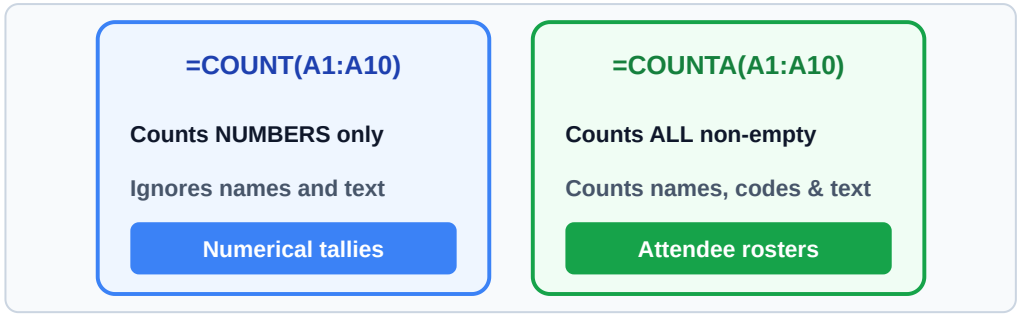
⚠️ Watch Out: Don't write '=SUM(A1+A2)' — either write '=SUM(A1:A2)' or '=A1+A2'.

17. Spreadsheets: COUNT vs COUNTA

CREATING CONTENT

Count Numbers vs Count Non-Empty Cells

=COUNT(range): Counts ONLY cells containing NUMBERS. =COUNTA(range): Counts ALL non-empty cells (numbers, text, symbols). Think 'Count All' (COUNTA).



★ Golden Rule: Use COUNTA to count attendee names or text entries!

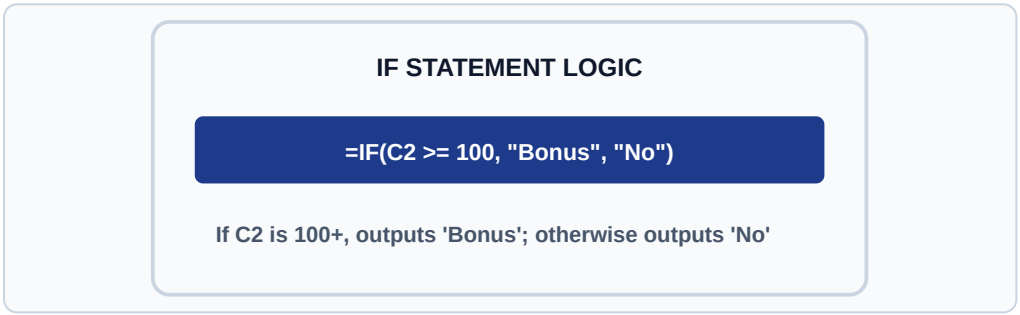
⚠️ Watch Out: If you use COUNT on a column of patient names, the answer will be 0!

18. Spreadsheets: Simple IF Statements

CREATING CONTENT

=IF(condition, value_if_true, value_if_false)

Syntax: 1. Test condition (e.g. B2>=50). 2. Value if TRUE in quotes ("Pass"). 3. Value if FALSE in quotes ("Fail"). Example: =IF(B2>=50, "Pass", "Fail").



★ Golden Rule: Text outputs in IF statements MUST be enclosed in quotation marks ("..."!

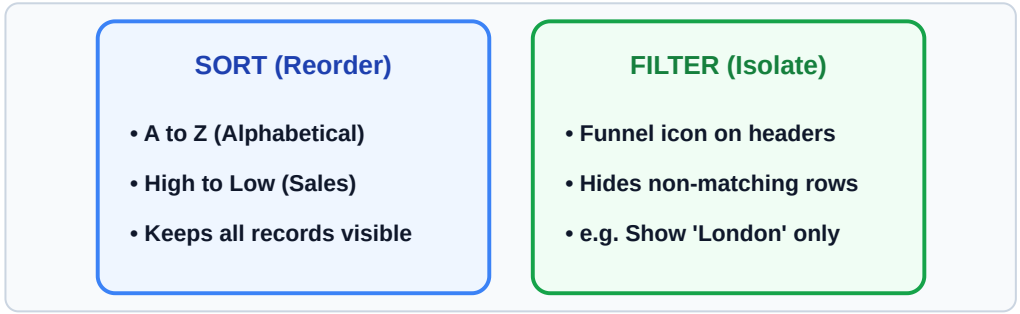
⚠️ Watch Out: Don't forget the commas separating the three arguments.

19. Spreadsheets: Sorting & Filtering

CREATING CONTENT

Order vs Isolate

Sort: Reorders rows (A–Z alphabetical, or Largest to Smallest numerical). Filter: Temporarily hides rows that do not match criteria (e.g. show ONLY customers in 'Oxford').



★ Golden Rule: Filtering hides rows; sorting changes their sequence!

⚠️ Watch Out: Make sure all data columns are selected before sorting, or columns will become mismatched!

Challenge: Spreadsheets: COUNT vs COUNTA

CREATING CONTENT

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 2.7

Which function should you use to count how many employees signed in on a text attendance sheet in cells B2 to B30?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

=COUNTA(B2:B30).

Challenge: Spreadsheets: SUM & AVERAGE

CREATING CONTENT

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 2.6

Write the function to calculate the average of sales in cells D3 to D15.

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

=AVERAGE(D3:D15).

Challenge: Spreadsheets: Sorting & Filtering

CREATING CONTENT

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 2.9

What spreadsheet tool would you use to view only employees who work in the 'Finance' department?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

The Filter tool (filtering the Department column by 'Finance').

Challenge: Spreadsheets: Simple IF Statements

CREATING CONTENT

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 2.8

Write an IF formula for cell D2 that displays 'Yes' if cell B2 is greater than 1000, and 'No' otherwise.

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

=IF(B2>1000, "Yes", "No").

20. Spreadsheets: Creating Charts

CREATING CONTENT

Titles, Axes & Legends

To score full marks on spreadsheet charts: 1. Select category labels AND numerical data together. 2. Choose appropriate chart type (Bar for categories, Line for trends). 3. Add Chart Title, Axis Titles, and Legend.

CHART LABELLING CHECKLIST

- [✓] Meaningful Chart Title at top
- [✓] Horizontal Axis Title (e.g. Month / Department)
- [✓] Vertical Axis Title (e.g. Revenue (£) / Patient Count)

⋆ Golden Rule: Every chart must have a clear descriptive Title and labelled X and Y axes!

⚠ Watch Out: Don't include the 'Total' row when highlighting data for a pie chart — it distorts the slices.

21. Presentations: Slide Design

CREATING CONTENT

The 6 × 6 Rule & Slide Masters

Best practice: 6 × 6 Rule: Maximum 6 bullet points per slide, with 6 words per bullet. Use consistent Slide Master layouts, high-contrast fonts (dark on light), and avoid distracting animations.

SLIDE PRESENTATION RULES

- 6 × 6 Rule: Avoid dense walls of text
- High-contrast colours for legibility
- Consistent corporate theme across all slides

⋆ Golden Rule: Slides are visual prompts for the speaker, not essays to read aloud!

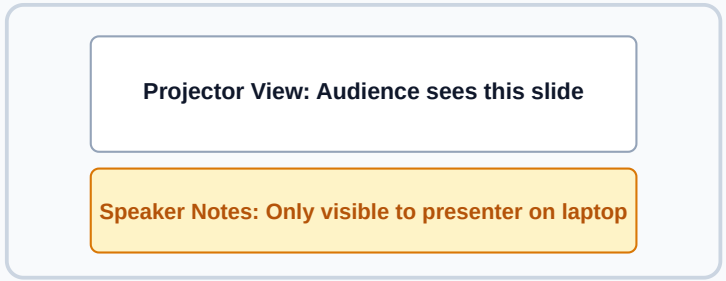
⚠ Watch Out: Don't use low-contrast text (e.g. yellow font on white background).

22. Presentations: Speaker Notes

CREATING CONTENT

Visible to Speaker Only

Speaker Notes Pane: Area underneath each slide where the presenter writes their talking script. In 'Presenter View', notes are visible on the speaker's laptop screen while the audience only sees the slides.



⋆ Golden Rule: Put detailed speech text in the Speaker Notes, NOT on the slide itself!

⚠ Watch Out: Make sure your display is set to 'Extend' rather than 'Duplicate' to use Presenter View.

23. Collaboration: Track Changes

CREATING CONTENT

Comments & Suggesting Edits

Track Changes records every edit (strikethroughs, insertions in coloured ink). Other reviewers can: 1. Add Comments to discuss points. 2. 'Accept' or 'Reject' individual changes before finalizing.

REVIEW & COLLABORATION

~~The project will end in June.~~

The project will conclude in August. (Inserted)

Review buttons: [✓ Accept] [✕ Reject]

⋆ Golden Rule: Always accept or reject all tracked changes before sending documents to clients!

⚠ Watch Out: Leaving tracked changes active can leak internal confidential comments.

Challenge: Presentations: Slide Design

CREATING CONTENT

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 2.11

State two design principles that make a presentation slide easy for an audience to read.

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

1. Using bullet points instead of dense paragraphs. 2. Maintaining high contrast between text and background.

Challenge: Spreadsheets: Creating Charts

CREATING CONTENT

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 2.10

Which chart type is best for showing sales figures over 12 consecutive months?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

A line chart (ideal for showing continuous trends over time).

Challenge: Collaboration: Track Changes

CREATING CONTENT

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 2.13

What tool allows multiple team members to review a Word document and propose text edits without overwriting the original text?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

Track Changes.

Challenge: Presentations: Speaker Notes

CREATING CONTENT

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 2.12

Where should a presenter put detailed talking points that they do not want the audience to see on the main screen?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

In the Speaker Notes pane (using Presenter View).

24. Exporting & Converting to PDF

CREATING CONTENT

File → Export → Create PDF

Why export to PDF: 1. Universal compatibility (opens on any phone/PC without needing Word). 2. Preserves exact layout, fonts, and images. 3. Prevents accidental editing. 4. Smaller file size.

WHY CONVERT TO PDF?

- ✓ Formatting is locked and preserved
- ✓ Opens on any device without Microsoft Office
- ✓ Ideal format for invoices, certificates & CVs

⋆ Golden Rule: Save as PDF to lock your formatting before printing or emailing!

⚠️ Watch Out: Always keep your original .docx or .xlsx master file in case you need to edit later.

25. Professional Email Structure

COMMUNICATING ONLINE

Clear, Actionable Email Hierarchy

A professional email includes: 1. A clear, specific subject line. 2. A polite formal salutation. 3. Concise body paragraphs stating the main purpose. 4. An unambiguous call-to-action or deadline. 5. A professional sign-off and signature block.

PROFESSIONAL EMAIL STRUCTURE

Subject: Project Update: Q3 Budget Review - 14 Oct

Dear Ms Higgins, / Hi Team,

Please find attached the updated figures for your review.

Action: Kindly confirm sign-off by 5pm this Thursday.

Kind regards, | Alex Patel (Senior Analyst)

⋆ Golden Rule: Always write a descriptive subject line before composing the email body!

⚠️ Watch Out: Avoid vague or blank subject lines like 'urgent' or 'hi' which trigger spam filters.

26. Email Fields: To, Cc & Bcc

COMMUNICATING ONLINE

Direct Action vs Courtesy vs Privacy

To: Direct recipients expected to read and take action. Cc (Carbon Copy): People kept informed for visibility; no direct action expected. Bcc (Blind Carbon Copy): Hidden recipients; preserves privacy and complies with UK GDPR when emailing groups.

To:	Action Owner (e.g. John - needs to complete task)
Cc:	Informed only (e.g. Manager - keeps in the loop)
Bcc:	Hidden / Blind (protects privacy & UK GDPR) Recipients cannot see each other's email addresses

⋆ Golden Rule: Use Bcc for group emails to keep recipient email addresses private!

⚠️ Watch Out: Putting client emails in 'To' or 'Cc' is a direct GDPR violation.

27. Email Attachments & Cloud Links

COMMUNICATING ONLINE

Direct File vs Cloud Share Link

Email Attachments: Suitable for small individual files under 15-20 MB. Cloud Links (OneDrive, Google Drive): Best for large files, videos, or collaborative live editing. Cloud links prevent mailbox quota exhaustion and allow permission revoking.

DIRECT ATTACHMENT

- • File size limit (~20 MB)
- • Static snapshot copy
- • Cannot revoke access

Best for: Final invoices, receipts

CLOUD SHARE LINK

- • Unlimited file size
- • Real-time live collaboration
- • Permissions can be revoked

Best for: Large decks, team docs

⋆ Golden Rule: Use cloud links instead of heavy attachments to avoid bouncing emails!

⚠️ Watch Out: Check sharing permissions before sending a cloud link so recipients can actually open it.

Challenge: Professional Email Structure

COMMUNICATING ONLINE

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 3.1

Why is 'Q3 Budget Review - Approval Needed by Thursday' far more effective than just 'Budget' as an email subject line?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

It specifies the exact topic, the action required (approval), and the deadline, allowing the recipient to prioritize immediately.

Challenge: Exporting & Converting to PDF

CREATING CONTENT

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 2.14

Give two reasons why job applications require CVs to be submitted as PDF files.

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

1. Formatting, fonts, and layout remain fixed across all devices. 2. The recipient cannot easily edit or corrupt the text.

Challenge: Email Attachments & Cloud Links

COMMUNICATING ONLINE

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 3.3

Why might an email containing a 65 MB video attachment fail to reach the recipient?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

Most email providers enforce attachment size limits between 20 MB and 25 MB, causing larger files to be rejected.

Challenge: Email Fields: To, Cc & Bcc

COMMUNICATING ONLINE

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 3.2

A community organiser is emailing 120 residents about a neighbourhood meeting. Should they use To, Cc, or Bcc?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

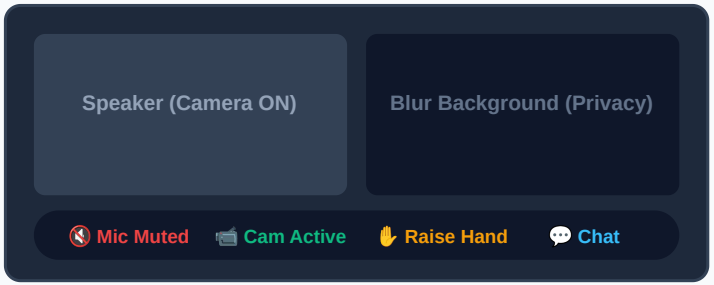
Bcc (Blind Carbon Copy), to prevent exposing residents' private email addresses to one another in violation of UK GDPR.

28. Video Calling Setup & Etiquette

COMMUNICATING ONLINE

Mute, Backgrounds & Participation

Key video meeting protocols: 1. Keep microphone MUTED when not speaking to eliminate background noise. 2. Enable Background Blur or a neutral virtual background for privacy. 3. Use 'Raise Hand' feature to speak without interrupting. 4. Maintain eye contact near camera.



★ Golden Rule: Mute your microphone when not speaking to eliminate background noise!

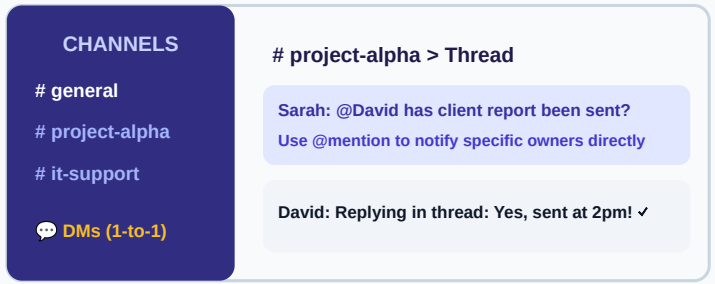
⚠ Watch Out: Place light in FRONT of you — backlighting turns you into a shadow.

29. Workplace Messaging (Teams/Slack)

COMMUNICATING ONLINE

Channels vs Direct Messages (DMs)

Organise chat communication efficiently: 1. Use Channels for team-wide project topics and public discussions. 2. Use Direct Messages (DMs) for private, 1-to-1 conversations. 3. Use thread replies to keep specific conversations clustered. 4. Use @mentions sparingly.



★ Golden Rule: Use @mentions only when an immediate action or response is required!

⚠ Watch Out: Avoid @everyone for routine updates — it creates notification fatigue.

30. Online Calendar Invites & Scheduling

COMMUNICATING ONLINE

Creating Invites, Times & Agendas

To schedule effective meetings: 1. Add clear Title and meeting purpose. 2. Specify Date, Start time, and Duration. 3. Include meeting link (Teams/Meet) or physical room. 4. Use Scheduling Assistant to check attendees' free/busy availability. 5. Include an agenda.



★ Golden Rule: Always include the video link and agenda in the calendar description!

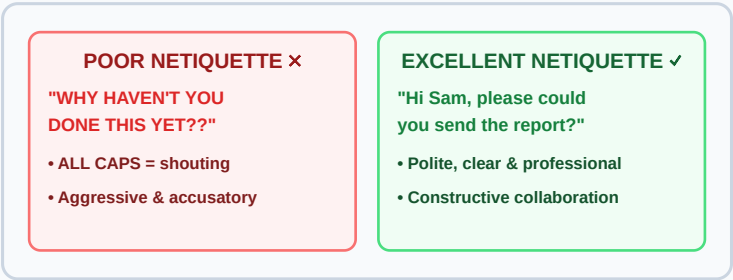
⚠ Watch Out: Check colleague availability and working hours before sending invites.

31. Digital Netiquette & Tone

COMMUNICATING ONLINE

Written Nuance in Online Spaces

Digital messages lack body language and vocal inflections. Follow core netiquette: 1. NEVER WRITE IN ALL CAPS (read as shouting). 2. Avoid ambiguous sarcasm or irony. 3. Be polite, constructive, and concise. 4. Proofread messages before hitting send.



★ Golden Rule: Re-read your message through the recipient's eyes before clicking send!

⚠ Watch Out: Words typed in CAPITAL LETTERS are universally understood online as shouting.

Challenge: Workplace Messaging (Teams/Slack)

COMMUNICATING ONLINE

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 3.5

When should you discuss a work issue in a public project channel rather than sending a private direct message?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

When the information, decision, or answer is relevant to the entire team and should be searchable in future.

Challenge: Video Calling Setup & Etiquette

COMMUNICATING ONLINE

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 3.4

What two features in Microsoft Teams help protect your home privacy and prevent talking over colleagues?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

Background Blur (protects privacy) and the 'Raise Hand' button (prevents speaking over others).

Challenge: Digital Netiquette & Tone

COMMUNICATING ONLINE

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 3.7

Why is typing workplace communications in capital letters considered unacceptable digital practice?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

Typing in all capital letters is universally perceived as shouting, aggressive, or hostile.

Challenge: Online Calendar Invites & Scheduling

COMMUNICATING ONLINE

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 3.6

What calendar feature lets you view whether your colleagues are in other meetings before scheduling an appointment?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

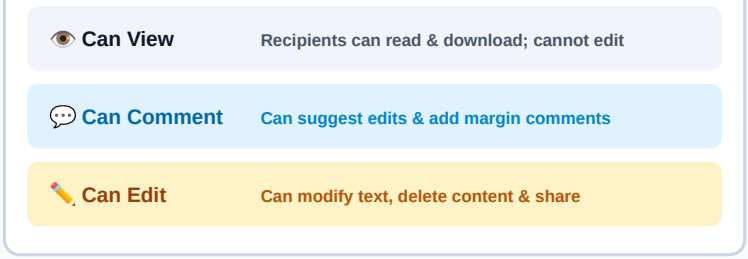
The Scheduling Assistant (or 'Find a Time' view).

32. Document Sharing Permissions

COMMUNICATING ONLINE

Viewer vs Commenter vs Editor Roles

Protect cloud files by assigning the minimum required permissions: 1. Can View (Read-Only; cannot modify or delete content). 2. Can Comment (can read and leave margin feedback notes without altering text). 3. Can Edit (Full read/write permissions). Restrict links to specific people.



★ Golden Rule: Set permissions to 'Can View' unless collaborative editing is needed!

⚠ Watch Out: Never set links to 'Anyone with the link can edit' for company files.

33. Secure Online Purchasing & HTTPS

TRANSACTING ONLINE

HTTPS, SSL Encryption & Merchant Checks

Safe online shopping requirements: 1. Confirm the address begins with 'https://' with a padlock icon (data encrypted in transit). 2. Inspect domain spelling carefully to avoid fake clones. 3. Check independent reviews on Trustpilot. 4. Ensure clear contact details and postal address exist.



★ Golden Rule: Look for 'https://' and the padlock icon before entering card data!

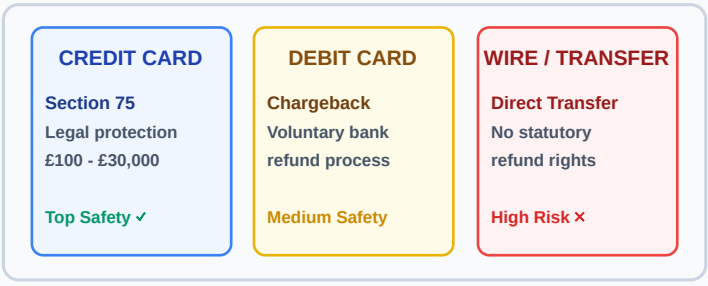
⚠ Watch Out: Avoid online shopping on public, open Wi-Fi networks without a VPN.

34. Payment Methods & Section 75

TRANSACTING ONLINE

Credit vs Debit vs Digital Wallets

Payment safeguards: 1. Credit Cards: UK Section 75 Consumer Credit Act legally protects single purchases over £100 up to £30,000 if goods fail to arrive or seller collapses. 2. Debit Cards: Protected by voluntary Chargeback scheme. 3. Digital Wallets (Apple Pay/PayPal): Tokenises card details.



★ Golden Rule: Use a credit card for £100+ purchases for Section 75 legal refund cover!

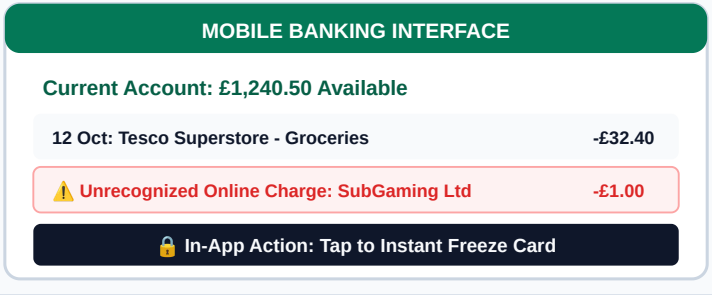
⚠ Watch Out: Direct bank transfers offer almost no buyer protection if scammed.

35. Online Banking & Statements

TRANSACTING ONLINE

Reconciling Transactions & Card Freezes

Banking safely online: 1. Regularly review transaction history to spot unauthorized micro-charges. 2. Verify all active Direct Debits and standing orders. 3. Immediately 'Freeze' lost cards inside mobile banking app. 4. Never access banking on public shared PCs.



★ Golden Rule: Review online banking weekly to spot unauthorised charges promptly!

⚠ Watch Out: Never share one-time passcodes (OTPs) with anyone — banks never ask.

Challenge: Secure Online Purchasing & HTTPS

TRANSACTING ONLINE

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 4.1

What does the 's' in 'https://' indicate about the communication between your browser and the website?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

It stands for 'Secure' (SSL/TLS encryption), meaning data transferred between your browser and the site is encrypted.

Challenge: Document Sharing Permissions

COMMUNICATING ONLINE

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 3.8

Which sharing permission should you give a client to let them review a proposal and suggest changes without risking text deletion?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

'Can Comment' (Commenter permission).

Challenge: Online Banking & Statements

TRANSACTING ONLINE

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 4.3

What in-app mobile banking tool allows you to immediately block all transactions if you misplace your card?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

The 'Freeze' or 'Lock Card' toggle switch.

Challenge: Payment Methods & Section 75

TRANSACTING ONLINE

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 4.2

Why is paying with a credit card safer than paying via direct bank transfer when purchasing a £400 laptop online?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

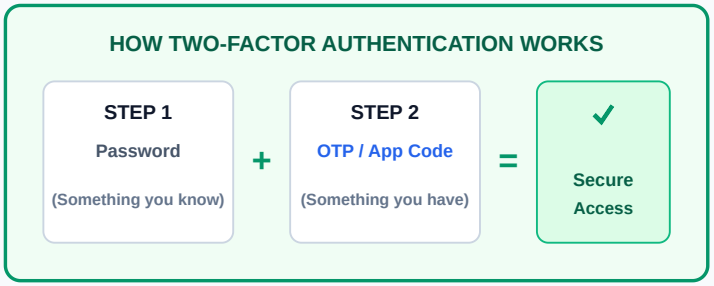
Under Section 75 of the Consumer Credit Act, the credit card provider is jointly liable with the retailer if goods are faulty or never delivered.

36. Two-Factor Authentication (2FA)

TRANSACTING ONLINE

Something You Know + Something You Have

2FA adds an essential second security barrier: 1. Factor 1: Password (something you know). 2. Factor 2: One-Time Passcode (OTP) via authenticator app, SMS, or biometric fingerprint (something you have/are). If hackers steal your password, they still cannot gain access.



★ Golden Rule: Enable 2FA everywhere — authenticator apps are much safer than SMS!

⚠ Watch Out: SMS codes are vulnerable to SIM-swap fraud; prefer app-based 2FA.

37. Accessing Public Services Online

TRANSACTING ONLINE

GOV.UK, NHS App & Council Portals

Official UK public digital services: 1. GOV.UK: Apply for passports, check tax codes, Universal Credit, and renew driving licences. 2. NHS App: Order repeat prescriptions, view GP records, book blood tests. 3. Local Council: Pay Council Tax, register to vote, apply for parking permits.



★ Golden Rule: Access public services directly via GOV.UK or NHS.UK official domains!

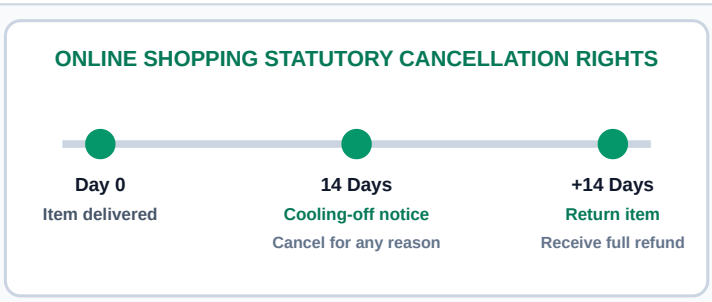
⚠ Watch Out: Beware of copycat websites charging fees for free public services.

38. Online Consumer Rights & Returns

TRANSACTING ONLINE

14-Day Cooling-Off Period & Refunds

UK Consumer Contracts Regulations 2013 give statutory rights for online distance shopping: 1. 14 days from delivery date to cancel an order for any reason. 2. A further 14 days to return the item. 3. Full refund including standard delivery cost. Exemptions: Perishables, custom-made goods, unsealed hygiene items.



★ Golden Rule: Online orders give a statutory 14-day cooling-off cancellation right!

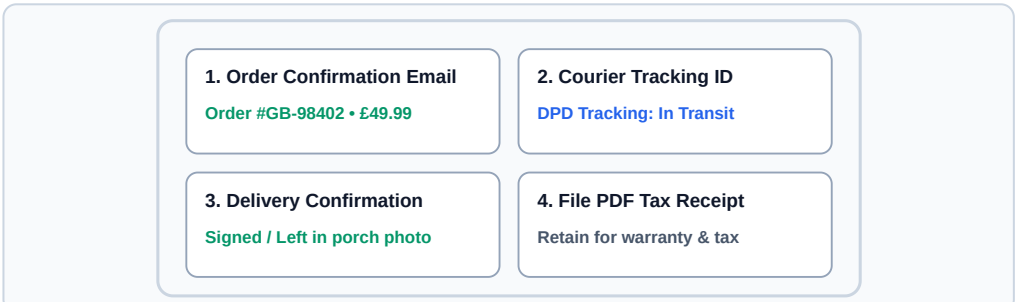
⚠ Watch Out: Perishable and custom-made items are exempt from statutory returns.

39. Digital Receipts & Order Tracking

TRANSACTING ONLINE

Saving Proof of Purchase & Tracking

Keep accurate records for online transactions: 1. Save confirmation emails and PDF receipts in a dedicated 'Purchases' email folder. 2. Record the Order ID, vendor name, and date. 3. Use parcel tracking numbers to track courier delivery progress. 4. Inspect goods promptly on arrival.



★ Golden Rule: Save order confirmations into a dedicated receipts folder or cloud PDF!

⚠ Watch Out: Retailers can close accounts — always save an offline copy of receipts.

Challenge: Accessing Public Services Online

TRANSACTING ONLINE

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 4.5

How can you verify that a website offering driving licence renewals is the legitimate government service?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

Check that the URL ends in '.gov.uk' (the official UK government domain).

Challenge: Two-Factor Authentication (2FA)

TRANSACTING ONLINE

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 4.4

Why does two-factor authentication (2FA) protect your account even if a cybercriminal steals your password?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

Because login is blocked without the second factor (the unique code sent to your physical device or generated by your authenticator app).

Challenge: Digital Receipts & Order Tracking

TRANSACTING ONLINE

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 4.7

What key piece of information in an order confirmation email is required when contacting customer support about a missing parcel?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

The Order Reference Number (Order ID).

Challenge: Online Consumer Rights & Returns

TRANSACTING ONLINE

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 4.6

A customer purchases a pair of standard trainers online. How many days do they legally have after delivery to cancel the purchase?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

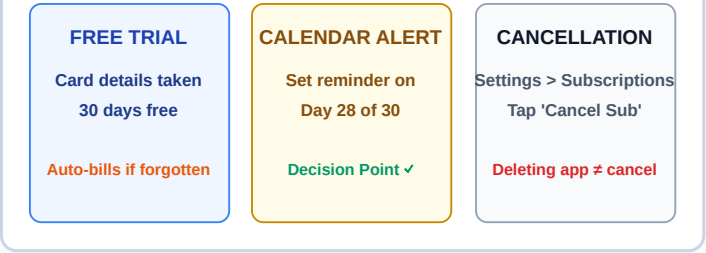
14 calendar days from the day of delivery under the Consumer Contracts Regulations.

40. Subscriptions & Auto-Renewals

TRANSACTING ONLINE

Free Trial Traps & Direct Debit Guarantee

Managing online subscriptions: 1. 'Free trials' automatically roll into paid monthly recurring subscriptions unless cancelled prior to renewal. 2. Set a calendar alert 2 days before the trial finishes. 3. Manage subscriptions via Apple App Store / Google Play subscriptions. 4. Direct Debit Guarantee covers unnotified debits.



⋆ **Golden Rule: Set a calendar alert to review or cancel free trials before renewal!**

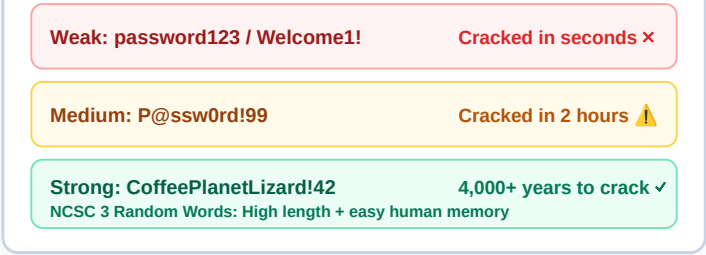
⚠️ **Watch Out: Deleting an app does NOT cancel an active recurring paid subscription.**

41. Strong Passwords & Passphrases

SAFE & RESPONSIBLE

Length Trumps Complexity: Three Random Words

UK NCSC recommendation: Use 'Three Random Words' to build long, uncrackable passphrases that are easy to remember (e.g. 'CoffeePlanetLizard!'). Minimum 12-16 characters. Combine uppercase, lowercase, numbers, and symbols. NEVER reuse passwords across accounts.



⋆ **Golden Rule: Combine three random words into a 14+ character secure passphrase!**

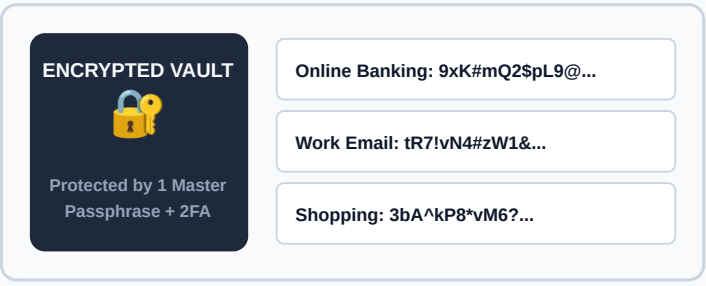
⚠️ **Watch Out: Never reuse your primary email password on any other website.**

42. Password Managers & Safe Storage

SAFE & RESPONSIBLE

Encrypted Vaults & Unique Logins

Password managers (Bitwarden, 1Password, Apple Keychain) store all your passwords inside a military-grade encrypted digital vault. Benefits: 1. You only need to remember ONE strong Master Password. 2. Auto-generates random 20-character passwords. 3. Autofills logins on trusted sites.



⋆ **Golden Rule: Use a password manager so every account has a unique, strong password!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: Never write passwords on sticky notes or keep them in unencrypted files.**

43. Spotting Phishing & Smishing

SAFE & RESPONSIBLE

Urgency, Sender Spoofing & Malicious Links

Spotting fraudulent messages: 1. Artificial urgency ('Account suspended in 24 hrs!'). 2. Fake sender email domain (e.g. service@hmrc-tax-refunds.com instead of gov.uk). 3. Generic salutations ('Dear Customer'). 4. Suspicious links (hover cursor to view true destination URL).



⋆ **Golden Rule: Hover over links to verify the actual destination URL before clicking!**

⚠️ **Watch Out: HMRC and banks never text or email links asking for security details.**

Challenge: Strong Passwords & Passphrases

SAFE & RESPONSIBLE

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 5.1

Why is 'RocketTeapotBlanket!' a stronger password than 'P@ssw0rd1' despite being easier to remember?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

Because length is the primary defence against brute-force attacks; 19 characters takes centuries to crack, while 9 characters takes minutes.

Challenge: Subscriptions & Auto-Renewals

TRANSACTING ONLINE

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 4.8

If you delete a paid fitness application from your smartphone, will your recurring monthly payments stop automatically?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

No. You must explicitly cancel the subscription inside your device's App Store / Google Play account settings or provider website.

Challenge: Spotting Phishing & Smishing

SAFE & RESPONSIBLE

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 5.3

What should you do before clicking on a link in an unexpected email claiming your account has been compromised?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

Hover your mouse over the link to verify the true destination URL, or visit the official website directly via your browser.

Challenge: Password Managers & Safe Storage

SAFE & RESPONSIBLE

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 5.2

What is the primary security advantage of using a password manager over using the same password for 10 different websites?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

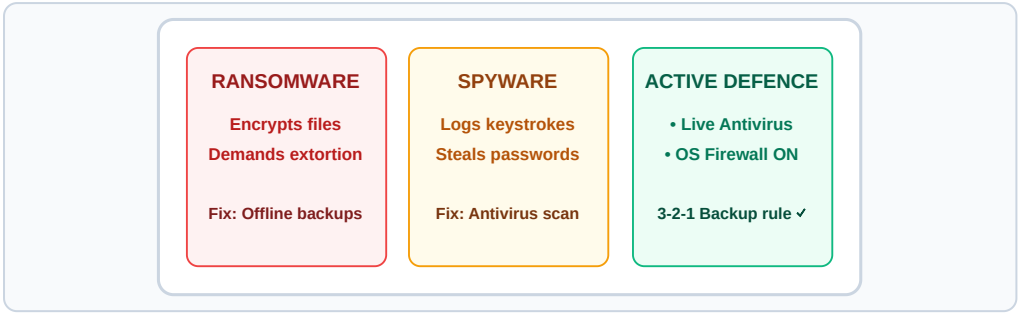
If one website suffers a security breach, your other accounts remain completely secure because each site has a unique password.

44. Malware, Viruses & Ransomware

SAFE & RESPONSIBLE

Malicious Software Types & Defence

Key malware categories: 1. Virus/Trojan: Malicious code hidden inside innocent-looking files. 2. Spyware/Keylogger: Silently records passwords and browsing habits. 3. Ransomware: Encrypts your files and demands money for decryption. Defence: Active antivirus and regular offline backups.



★ Golden Rule: Maintain offline backups of critical data to safeguard from ransomware!

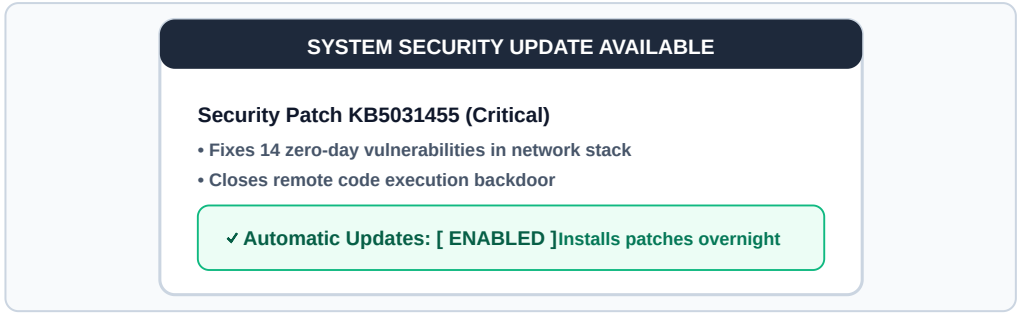
⚠️ Watch Out: Never enable macros on unexpected email attachments from strangers.

45. Software Updates & Security Patches

SAFE & RESPONSIBLE

Zero-Day Flaws & Automatic Updates

Software and operating system updates provide critical security patches that close vulnerabilities before cybercriminals exploit them. Always enable automatic updates for: Windows/macOS, smartphones (iOS/Android), web browsers (Chrome/Edge), and antivirus software.



★ Golden Rule: Enable automatic updates so operating systems and apps patch flaws fast!

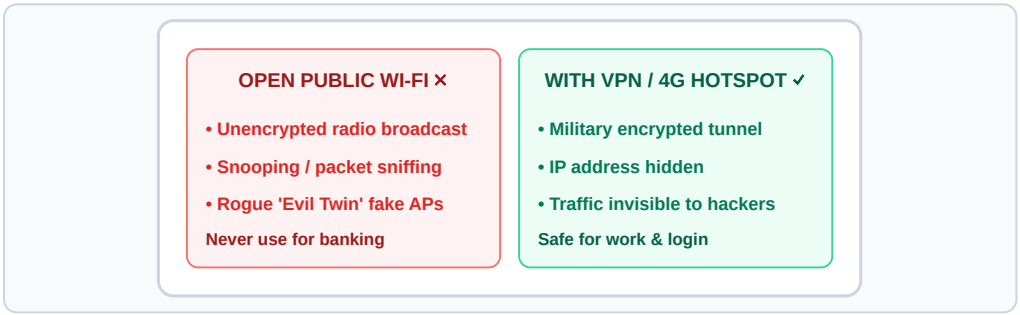
⚠️ Watch Out: Postponing security updates leaves systems vulnerable to known exploits.

46. Public Wi-Fi Risks & VPNs

SAFE & RESPONSIBLE

Unencrypted Networks & Encrypted Tunnels

Public Wi-Fi in cafes, hotels, and airports carries risks: 1. Man-in-the-Middle attacks (eavesdropping unencrypted packets). 2. Fake rogue hotspots ('Evil Twins'). Safety rules: Avoid banking on public Wi-Fi; use mobile 4G/5G tethering; use a reputable Virtual Private Network (VPN).



★ Golden Rule: Use mobile data hotspot or a VPN when connecting on public Wi-Fi!

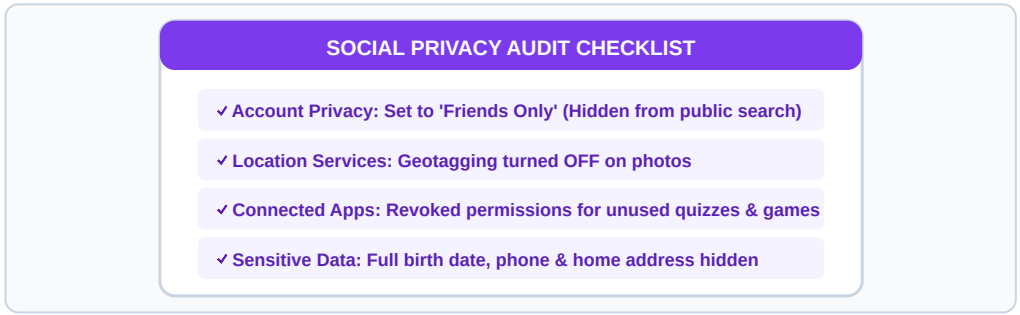
⚠️ Watch Out: Rogue open Wi-Fi hotspots can intercept unencrypted network passwords.

47. Social Media Privacy Settings

SAFE & RESPONSIBLE

Auditing Visibility, Location Tags & Permissions

Safeguarding social media profiles: 1. Set account visibility to 'Private' or 'Friends Only' (never Public). 2. Disable location tagging on posts and photos. 3. Audit third-party apps connected to your profile. 4. Never post identifying details (birth year, mother's maiden name, holiday dates).



★ Golden Rule: Keep profiles private and avoid posting live location updates when away!

⚠️ Watch Out: Never post photos of boarding passes — barcodes contain sensitive data.

Challenge: Software Updates & Security Patches

SAFE & RESPONSIBLE

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 5.5

Why is installing operating system updates vital even if you do not care about new visual features?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

Because updates contain security patches that fix discovered vulnerabilities, preventing hackers and malware from exploiting them.

Challenge: Malware, Viruses & Ransomware

SAFE & RESPONSIBLE

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 5.4

What is ransomware, and what proactive step best ensures you never have to pay a ransom to recover files?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

Ransomware is malicious software that encrypts your files and demands payment. Maintaining regular offline backups ensures you can restore files without paying.

Challenge: Social Media Privacy Settings

SAFE & RESPONSIBLE

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 5.7

Why is announcing on public social media that your family is departing for a 2-week holiday a significant security risk?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

It alerts potential burglars that your home will be unoccupied during that exact timeframe.

Challenge: Public Wi-Fi Risks & VPNs

SAFE & RESPONSIBLE

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 5.6

What does a Virtual Private Network (VPN) do to protect your data when using public Wi-Fi?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

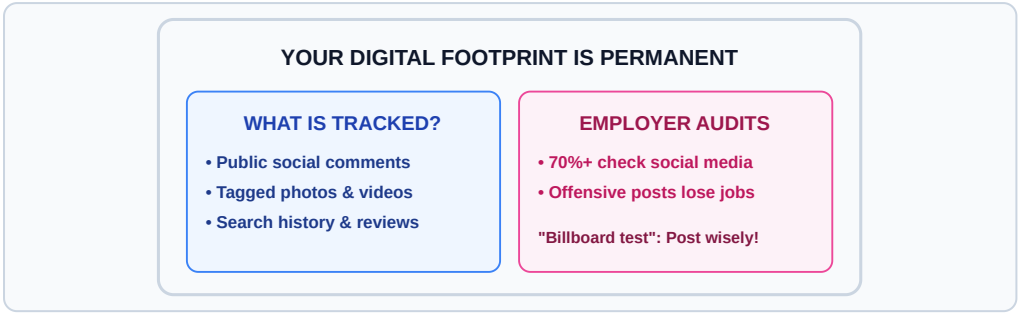
It creates an encrypted tunnel between your device and the internet, preventing anyone on the public network from viewing your data.

48. Digital Footprint & Reputation

SAFE & RESPONSIBLE

Permanent Traces & Employer Background Checks

Your digital footprint is the permanent trail of data left by your online activities: comments, posts, tagged photos, forum reviews. Facts: 1. Deleted posts can be archived or screenshotted. 2. 70%+ of UK employers check applicants' public online profiles. 3. Follow the 'billboard test'.



★ Golden Rule: Only post content you would be comfortable showing to an employer!

⚠️ Watch Out: Deleting a post does not remove cached versions or viewer screenshots.

49. Digital Wellbeing & Ergonomics

SAFE & RESPONSIBLE

The 20-20-20 Rule, Posture & Screen Limits

Health habits for computer users: 1. 20-20-20 Rule: Every 20 minutes, look at an object 20 feet away for 20 seconds to prevent digital eye strain. 2. Ergonomics: Top of screen at eye level, 90° elbow angle, feet flat. 3. Night light / Blue light filter to safeguard sleep cycles.



★ Golden Rule: Follow the 20-20-20 rule to prevent digital eye strain during desk work!

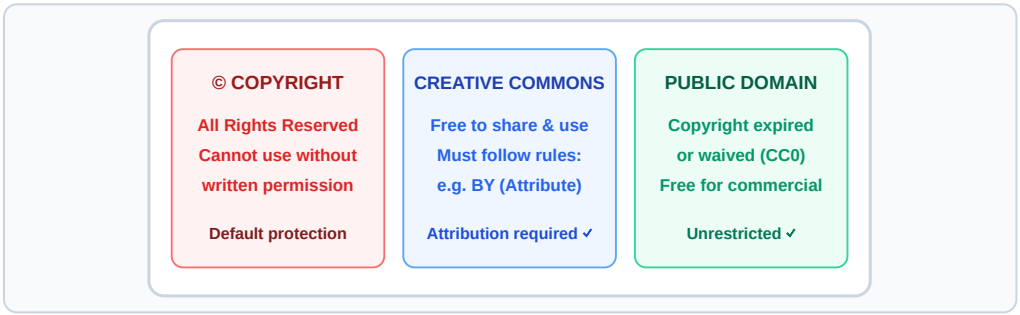
⚠️ Watch Out: Blue light in bed disrupts natural melatonin and degrades sleep quality.

50. Copyright & Creative Commons

SAFE & RESPONSIBLE

Intellectual Property, CC Licences & Attribution

Digital media ownership rules: 1. Copyright (©): Automatic legal ownership; you cannot copy or distribute without the author's permission. 2. Creative Commons (CC): Licences allowing free reuse under specific conditions (e.g. CC-BY requires attribution). 3. Public Domain: Free for anyone.



★ Golden Rule: Verify image license terms before using web images in published work!

⚠️ Watch Out: Google Image results are NOT automatically free or cleared for use.

Challenge: Digital Wellbeing & Ergonomics

SAFE & RESPONSIBLE

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 5.9

What does the 20-20-20 rule recommend to help prevent screen-related eye strain?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

Every 20 minutes, take a 20-second break to look at an object at least 20 feet away.

Challenge: Digital Footprint & Reputation

SAFE & RESPONSIBLE

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 5.8

What is a 'digital footprint', and how can it impact a person's career prospects?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

It is the permanent trail of online activity; employers routinely research candidates online, and inappropriate posts can result in rejected applications.

Challenge: Copyright & Creative Commons

SAFE & RESPONSIBLE

🎯 QUICK EXAM CHALLENGE — DFS 5.10

What does a Creative Commons 'Attribution' (CC-BY) license require you to do when using someone else's digital graphic?

✏️ Learner Scratchpad & Calculations — Formula Working Area

✓ STEP-BY-STEP OFFICIAL MODEL ANSWER — FULL MARKS

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